

Carbon Group

This group of elements is named after the first element in it, carbon. The carbon group is the first in the periodic table to contain metals, semi-metals, and a non-metal – most of which have played a significant role in human history.

Life forms

All living organisms on Earth contain carbon. The sugars, fats, and proteins used to build and power a living body are all complex carbon compounds. Plants build these compounds using carbon dioxide taken from the air, while animals get their supply of carbon from food.

